



Information & Portals

With hundreds of thousands of Web sites floating around in cyberspace, haven't you wished that there was a single site through which you could access the best? That's what portals do for you. Online portals are our windows to the Web world. They are single-access points, which help us explore the Net and find what we're looking for. These Indian portals bring

you all that you need from content to online services like e-shopping, auctions, as well as communication tools like e-mail, chat rooms, instant messengers, forums, message boards, etc. These portals are also popular hubs where surfers can converge together and be a part of an online community where they can exchange ideas and views online.

THE ABSOLUTE WINNER JUDGES CHOICE & POPULAR CHOICE



With its positioned content, services and communication tools, Rediff is India's 'Window to the Web'

Rediff is the undisputed king of Indian portals. It's probably one of the few sites to live up to its name in Indian cyberspace in terms of the quality and services offered to online users. The site is fairly well laid out. Whether it's producing content in-house or partnering with other Web sites, Rediff is constantly innovating to offers users nothing short of the best, be it news, buying information, finding a job, making financial decisions or just meeting people. The site also has an online shopping section featuring books, music, apparel, cassettes and CDs. It has services such as e-mail and Rediff 'Bol', an instant messenger.

Rediff has channels on news, finance, money, astrology, contests, e-cards, movies, women, contests, matrimonials and auctions. Rediff's Guide to the Net is a neat tool and so is Rediff Matchmaker. The latter is a great place to find the love in your life. If you are looking for information on a particular topic and have absolutely no clue as to where to start, then the Rediff search should be helpful. The search results are fairly accurate and it also has a fairly good Web directory.

And don't miss Rediff's 'hot keywords'—use this to locate some great sites.

Top of the Web (% votes)

Rediff	37
Indiatimes	34
123india	11
Indya	11
Sify	7

www.123india.com

123india.com has a wide variety of sections—cricket, contests, games, jokes, shopping, movies, music, news, finance, horoscopes and others. The online clubs are an interesting feature of 123india. They enable you to bond online with people who share the same interests as you. If clubs aren't your scene, then find the love of your life at the 'Love and Romance' nook. The site also offers services like e-mail, forums, chat, e-greetings, homepages, but you need to pay to use these services.

www.indiatimes.com

This portal from the Times Group offers an exhaustive range of sections covering information on a variety of topics ranging from entertainment to finance to services such as shopping, auctions, travel, bill pay and online education. It's also a great place to hang out, virtually speaking, and make friends using online dating clubs and chat rooms. Play your favourite strategy and word games online and if playing alone bores you, you can play games online with your friends.

THE OTHER NOMINEES

www.sify.com

Sify has a large number of sections in addition to an aggregation of a number of sites belonging to the Sify network. The site is quite well laid out and doesn't confuse you. Navigation is a breeze with drop-down menus and a well-categorised homepage. It provides services such as search, e-mail, e-greetings, shopping, news and so on. Check out 'The Café', which offers you a medium for communication with people online through clubs, messengers, chat, and mail services.

www.indya.com

Apart from the usual sections found on a portal, Indya also has channels such as Law, Health and Art. Couch potatoes will definitely love the TV guide in Indya, which features channels from the Star TV network. Read up on pre-views, schedules and even sign up for reminders for your favourite 'not to be missed' TV programs. If you are in search of screensavers or wallpapers or would like to take a sneak peek at cricket scores while you're working, you'll get all the necessary tools and utilities at 'Downloads'

